

Chris Tham

artist, consultant, cyclist, designer, musician, photographer, world traveller

I'm Chris Tham, an outrageous actualiser based in Sydney. I'm the founder and Junior Janitor of Hello Tham, a boutique strategy consulting company.

I live in Sydney, and love art, cycling, design, fashion, photography, music, and travel (not necessarily in those order). My work life has focused on technology and strategy, mainly in the finance industry.

This website has been built using a design system called Rosely.

Superpowers

AI Agents have skills. Humans have superpowers :-) My top three superpowers are my abilities to influence, think differently and be passionate.

Everyone has superpowers, skills or attributes that they possess that sets them apart from other people.

My top 3 superpowers are:

- **The ability to connect and empathise with people, and to be influential** - one colleague has even referred to me as an "evangelist." In my role as a strategist, I have the ability to relate to people and their motivations and concerns, and influence a better outcome for them and the organisation. I have led teams, coached and mentored individuals, guided and delivered organisational strategies that have made a difference. I use my skills each week in my consulting career, and also when teaching undergraduates and masters students at Torrens University.

- **The ability to think differently, and solve problems creatively** - at the heart of innovation is the need to look at things and situations from a different angle, to provide fresh and unique perspectives and to challenge herd thinking. My career has been full of forged paths, I established one of the earliest successful enterprise architecture practice in a large Australian organisation (MLC) and wrote my own job description, and created norms and roles which are now prevalent in the industry. I was an early pioneer in enabling citizen data scientists, and I deployed an LLM (GPT2) in 2018 to classify support calls into categories.
- **The ability to be passionate, and be able to dive deeply and learn quickly on many topics** - I am intensely curious about many topics (including the nature and concept of how we perceive reality). I love researching, learning and absorbing everything I can about topics that interest me, ranging from philosophy, Buddhism, music, photography, investment theory, developing websites and apps, and leveraging artificial intelligence to deliver outcomes. Often my passions can be useful to organisations and other people. For example, I have participated and led many Proof of Concepts to explore new technologies and help realise benefits. I am able to pick up new skills quickly and use them to provide outcomes.

Self evaluation against SFIA9:

Writing on Life, the Universe and Everything.

All of my long-form thoughts on life, the universe, and everything, collected in chronological order.

These articles are where I explore thoughts on various topics. The collection arranged chronologically so you can follow how these perspectives have evolved over time.

Work History

My professional career and work experience over the years.

I have a background in software engineering, solution architecture, and technical leadership. Here is a summary of my professional journey.

Junior Janitor

Hello Tham | *2017 — Present*

I am a Junior Janitor. My job is to sweep and mop the floors, clean the bathroom, sanitise the phones, and generally keep this place clean and welcoming to clients.

I am proud of what I do. I think I can help other organisations to be cleaner and more presentable.

Project Lead

Transport for NSW | *2016 — 2019*

I led the development of the Transport EQUIP Roadmap to realise desired business outcomes relating to a multi-year corporate shared services reform program at Transport for NSW. The roadmap impacts the entire cluster of operating agencies that together deliver transport services to NSW.

Management consultant (Consulting)

Broadspectrum | 2011 — 2016

Analytics Evangelist

Apr 2015 - Oct 2016

My role was to improve the use of analytics in the organisation to improve performance and gain insights. This was achieved by:

- developed the Analytics Landscape and Roadmap integrated to the IT Strategy
- promoting a self service approach to analytics across the organisation by the evaluation, selection, deployment and training of Tableau Desktop to cross functional stakeholders
- established a modern analytics platform consisting of Tableau Server and AWS Redshift, managed by an external service provider
- introduced the concept of "Analytics as a Service" provided by multiple partners and supported by an internal capability
- contributed to the development of Operational Metrics leveraging the modern analytics platform and the establishment of an internal Community of Practice and a Centre of Excellence
- contributed to the master data governance roadmap and established data governance and stewardship principles
- provided guidelines on appropriate use of analytics and reporting tools in the landscape depending on use case

Executive Manager IT Architecture & Design (interim)

Oct 2014 - Mar 2015

I led and managed the architecture function within Transfield Services on an interim basis until a suitable replacement is appointed.

My specific objectives as an interim leader included:

- Led the development of the IT Strategy and Roadmap (2015)
- Reviewing the roles, responsibilities and skill-sets of the Executive Manager position as well as -team/function
- Defining the role of the SAP strategy and technical relationship management responsibilities and where this will sit within the team
- Assisting in the recruitment of the Executive Manager
- Leveraging the role of partners (SAP and WIPRO) within the team
- Reviewing existing team skills and fit and make recommendations on realigning the team to the desired team profile
- Identifying and executing high priority strategic architecture initiatives
- Reviewing the forward workload plan for the team and ensuring the team delivers effective outcomes to stakeholders through a balanced mix of strategy and reactive work
- Lifting the team visibility, performance and engagement with stakeholders
- Improving team morale and effectiveness through selective coaching to assist them in their personal development plans

Strategy Consultant

Oct 2013 - Sep 2014

I have performed various consulting roles within Transfield Services, including:

- part of the tender team for a large public housing maintenance services contract that was successfully awarded to Transfield Services
- contributed to the scoping of service aspects of the new organisation operating model
- contributed to the development of an analytics strategy as establishment of working group

Project Leader, Business Process Improvement | Quality and Performance Excellence

Oct 2011 - Sep 2013

Developed the business case for an established a business improvement project to standardise business processes at a global level across all functional areas in the organisation, including both operational and support activities.

This included establishing a project classification framework (based on APQC), deploying a process mapping platform (iGrafx) and facilitating the development of business processes with business process owners and stakeholders.

Developed the platform for the Global Management System.

Strategy Consultant

May 2011 - Oct 2011

Created architecture capability within Transfield Services through leading a project to define the technology architecture and strategic migration roadmap, in preparation for a global platform refresh programme.

Developed an architecture governance model, including establishing and organising Strategic Architecture Governance Forum meetings on behalf of the CIO

Project managed 2 external reviews on the master data and blueprint definition of the platform refresh programme

Consultant (Consulting)

Thorogood & Associates | *2011 — 2011*

- Developed material for a social media workshop
- Consulted on the business case for an online campus and Western Sydney campus for the University of New England

Head of Strategy and Architecture

ING | *2008 — 2008*

Successfully established IT Strategy and Architecture Function (team size: approximately 20) for ING Australia (against a prior history of several failed attempts to create an organisation wide architecture team).

Key functions include technology strategy and innovation facilitation, enterprise architecture, solution architecture and solution design/estimation.

Defined the technology strategy and architecture governance model for ING Australia, as part of an overall technology operating model, including the establishment of the Technology Working Group (overall technology

governance body), Technical Review Board (strategy and architecture review forum).

Delivered technology roadmaps for key ING business units including Life Risk, Group Risk, Direct Insurances and provided input in the development of medium term plans for Wealth Management and Corporate Finance business units.

Head of Architecture

NAB | *2005 — 2008*

Strategy and Architecture Consultant (2007)

Provided key input to development of Integrated Platform strategy for NAB Australian region to consolidate NAB technology and vendor diversity to four key strategic partners.

Developed strategy and architecture for the NAB Corporate Centre functions (including Group Finance, Group Risk, Group Treasury, Group Audit, Corporate Secretariat).

Part of a business strategy team that developed an Australian region business process model.

Head of Architecture, Technology – Retail Banking Australia (2006)

Reinvigorated an architecture team that has lacked stable leadership for the last 3 years through a combination of personal coaching, targeted

team building activities, and external hire (doubled size of team)

Implemented new team operating model via a consultative approach

Improved team involvement and engagement in key projects from minimal to mandatory (with all significant projects having an architect accountable for successful delivery of agreed architecture) Delivered several target architectures in the areas of document production, imaging/workflow and electronic forms

Head of Architecture, Technology – Distribution (2005)

Created a new architecture function within a new business unit encompassing all distribution channels within NAB (retail banking, private banking, business banking, brokered, financial advisers).

Team delivered a Sales, Servicing and Channels business architecture. As an individual, seconded for part of the period as the team lead for the architecture stream of the 2005 Technology Strategy for the Australian region.

Head of Architecture

MLC | 1998 — 2005

Established the architecture function at MLC in a background of MLC re-establishing strategic control over technology from a fully outsourced IT operation (managed by IBM GSA).

Oversaw the introduction of various strategic applications and technologies into MLC: including AdviserCentral, Compass, Masterkey, Siebel

Established architecture governance processes, some elements of which are now used throughout NAB

Consulted to the establishment of architecture governance processes at NAB's European operations, including Clydesdale and Yorkshire Banks, and NAB's wealth management operations in Europe.

Established solution architecture role at MLC (and subsequently introduced as a standard role within NAB)

Led the definition of MLC's IT Strategy in 1999 and led the application architecture stream in the 2001 IT Strategy.

Part of team defining MLC's Enterprise Medium Term Vision, and business case for initiation of Amazon Programme (\$200m spend over 2001-2002).

Senior Consultant

HP | 1993 — 1998

My speciality was providing architecture consulting services to a number of clients within HP's Professional Services Division. Clients included ANZ, Telstra, and Boral. Key achievement included developing a technology infrastructure strategy, a server upgrade business case that was approved by the Board, and contributed to the development of a data centre consolidation business case for Boral.

Senior Consultant

NCR | 1991 — 1993

Consulted to various organisations, including St. George Bank, Franklins, Rockmans, Telstra, focusing on architecture, UNIX Server and RDBMS pre- and post-sales activities.

Treasury Analyst

State Bank Victoria | 1990 — 1991

- Systems analysis and software development
- Financial instruments pricing and risk analysis

Systems Analyst

Options Technology | 1987 — 1990

- Systems analysis and software development
- Financial instruments pricing and risk analysis

System Administrator

Bain & Company | 1985 — 1987

System administration and software development

Education

My academic background and qualifications.

I am a lifelong learner. Here is a summary of my formal education and academic achievements.

Master of Information Technology

UNSW Sydney | 2014 — 2015

Focused on advanced topics in information technology, including database systems, networking, and security.

Bachelor of Computer Science

University of Sydney | 2010 — 2013

Studied core computer science principles, including algorithms, data structures, and software engineering.

Websites I have made.

I've worked on tons of little projects over the years but these are the ones that I'm most proud of.

Many of these projects are open-source, so if you see something that piques your interest, check out the code and contribute if you have ideas for how it can be improved.

Things I have created.

I love creating all sorts of things. Here is a selection of music and videos that I have made.

This page gathers a selection of orchestral and electronic music I have composed, arranged, produced, and shared, including studio work, live-inspired experiments, and personal creative milestones.

Things I use and love.

Here's a big list of all of my favorite stuff, that I use everyday, or at least whenever I can. I love using good quality tools and equipment.

Over the years, I've refined this setup to focus on tools that are reliable, thoughtfully designed, and a joy to use. Whether it's software, computing gear, music production equipment, audio-visual components, or photography kit, each item here has earned its place through frequent use and long-term value.